

# THE UNSEEN SUFFERING OF OLD OR SICK COWS & BUFFALOES

They gave us milk, strength and life... Now they need our care.

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**THE UNSEEN SUFFERING OF OLD OR SICK COWS & BUFFALOES**
Think Feel Act ॐ

They gave us milk, strength and life... Now they need our care.

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|  <p><b>SUMMER</b><br/>HEAT, DEHYDRATION, SUFFERING</p> <p><i>No shade...<br/>No water...<br/>Only pain...</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Scorching heat causes heat stroke and body weakness.</li> <li>Dehydration leads to kidney problems and loss of appetite.</li> <li>Less grass and dry fodder, poor nutrition.</li> <li>Flies and infections increase skin diseases.</li> <li>They just want a cool place, water and a little love.</li> </ul>                                                  |  <p><b>RAINY SEASON</b><br/>DAMP, DISEASES, INFECTIONS</p> <p><i>Cold rain...<br/>Wet body...<br/>No shelter...</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Constant wetness causes fever, respiratory problems and joint pain.</li> <li>Foot rot, skin infections and maggot wounds become common.</li> <li>Fodder gets spoiled, leading to malnutrition.</li> <li>Mud and slippery ground make it hard to stand and walk.</li> <li>They shiver, get weak and need warmth, food and shelter.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  <p><b>WINTER</b><br/>COLD, ILLNESS, HELPLESSNESS</p> <p><i>Freezing cold...<br/>No warmth...<br/>No protection...</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Severe cold causes pneumonia, respiratory and joint problems.</li> <li>Old and weak animals can't generate body heat.</li> <li>Less green fodder, more hay, often of poor quality.</li> <li>Increased risk of infections and skin diseases.</li> <li>They need a warm shelter, good food and compassionate care.</li> </ul>                                                                                        |
| <p><b>! WHY?</b><br/>THEY ARE ABANDONED</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Decline in milk production (especially for farmers).</li> <li>High maintenance cost for old or sick animals.</li> <li>Lack of veterinary care and proper treatment.</li> <li>Scarcity of fodder and grazing land.</li> <li>Urbanization and changing lifestyles.</li> <li>Many are left on roads, near temples, auction markets or in remote areas.</li> </ul> <p><i>They gave us everything...<br/>Why do we leave them behind?</i></p> <p><b>They are not just animals...<br/>They are our responsibility.</b></p> | <p><b>✓ SOLUTIONS</b><br/>BY COMMON MEN &amp; GOVERNMENT</p> <div style="display: flex;"> <div style="width: 50%;"> <p><b>WHAT CAN WE DO</b><br/>(As Common Men / Society)</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Adopt and provide regular food, water and basic care.</li> <li>Arrange timely veterinary treatment and help in emergencies.</li> <li>Support cow shelters (Gaushalas) and local animal care groups.</li> <li>Avoid cruelty, neglect and illegal trading.</li> <li>Spread awareness and encourage others to help.</li> </ul> <p><b>Small actions make a big difference!</b></p> </div> <div style="width: 50%;"> <p><b>WHAT GOVERNMENT CAN DO</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Stricter implementation of animal protection laws and anti-cruelty rules.</li> <li>Increase funding for Gaushalas, veterinary hospitals and rescue centers.</li> <li>Ensure regular supply of fodder, water and nutritious feed.</li> <li>Provide pension or support for old and unproductive animals.</li> <li>Take strong action against abandonment, illegal sale and cruelty.</li> </ul> <p><b>Stronger laws + Better facilities = A kinder India</b></p> </div> </div> | <p><b>ALTERNATE SOLUTIONS</b><br/>BY RESCUERS &amp; CAREGIVERS</p> <p><i>They don't just save animals...<br/>They save lives — including humans.</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Rescue abandoned, old and sick cows and buffaloes from roads, markets and danger zones.</li> <li>Provide proper medical treatment, rehabilitation and long-term care.</li> <li>Ensure nutritious food, clean water and comfortable shelter.</li> <li>Give them love, respect and a peaceful life.</li> <li>Many rescuers also support other living beings and needy humans with food, medicine and hope.</li> </ul> <p><b>Their sacrifice is our inspiration...</b></p> |

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**RESPECT • COMPASSION • CARE • PROTECTION • A BETTER TOMORROW**
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Save an old or sick cow/buffalo... Save a life... Save our culture... Save our humanity... Jai Gau Mata | Jai Bharat

appeal: old, sick, weak and abandoned cattle deserve humane care regardless of a person's income, status, religion, occupation

The central question: When an animal has spent years serving a household, community or farm, what do we owe that animal when age, illness or declining productivity arrives?

# 1. THE COW FAMILY & THE BUFFALO FAMILY — ONE RESPONSIBILITY

The poster speaks about both cows and buffaloes. Their species differ, but the ethical responsibility described here is shared: an old, sick or disabled animal should not become invisible simply because it is no longer productive.

| <div>❑ COW FAMILY</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <div>❑ BUFFALO FAMILY</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
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| <div>Cows may be kept for milk, breeding, farm work, companionship or cultural reasons. With age or illness, they may require more feed, veterinary attention, comfortable flooring and protection from weather. The poster asks society to see the individual animal behind the economic role.</div> | <div>Buffaloes can face many of the same challenges: declining milk production, costly chronic illness, mobility problems, poor nutrition and abandonment. Their large body size can make transport, housing and treatment more demanding. They too need shade, clean water, suitable feed, safe flooring and medical care.</div> |

## The principle is simple

Productivity is not the measure of a life. A decline in milk production or working ability may change the economics of care, but it does not erase the animal's capacity to feel pain, fear, hunger, thirst, cold and comfort.

## 2. SUFFERING CHANGES WITH THE SEASON

The poster shows three seasons because neglect can become dangerous in different ways throughout the year. The same old or sick animal may need different forms of protection in summer, monsoon and winter.

| <div>☀ <b>SUMMER</b></div> <div><b>Heat • Dehydration • Weakness</b></div>                                                                                                                                                                           | <div>☔ <b>RAINY SEASON</b></div> <div><b>Dampness • Infection • Mud</b></div>                                                                                                                                                                              | <div>❄ <b>WINTER</b></div> <div><b>Cold • Illness • Helplessness</b></div>                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heat stress can cause weakness and dehydration. Water shortages, inadequate shade, poor-quality fodder and flies can worsen suffering. Older animals may be less able to cope with heat and may need easier access to water and a cool resting area. | Constant wetness can contribute to skin disease, foot problems, respiratory illness and discomfort. Muddy ground can make standing difficult, especially for animals with arthritis, weakness or hoof disease. Spoiled fodder can also threaten nutrition. | Cold weather is particularly difficult for thin, elderly or ill animals. Respiratory disease, joint pain and reduced mobility may become more serious. Dry bedding, wind protection, adequate nutrition and veterinary care are essential. |

Minimum seasonal care: clean water • adequate nutritious feed • shade or dry shelter • safe flooring • hygiene • parasite and wound care • timely veterinary assessment • protection from traffic and dangerous locations.

### 3. WHY ARE THEY ABANDONED?

The poster identifies real pressures that can contribute to abandonment. Understanding them is important because prevention requires more than blaming an individual household.

|                                             |                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Declining milk production</b>            | For some farming households, a fall in production can make continued care financially difficult.                       |
| <b>High maintenance costs</b>               | Chronic disease, medicines, veterinary visits, special feed and mobility support can become expensive.                 |
| <b>Lack of veterinary access</b>            | When affordable and timely veterinary services are unavailable, treatable problems may become severe.                  |
| <b>Scarcity of fodder and grazing</b>       | Changing land use, drought and rising feed costs can make adequate nutrition difficult.                                |
| <b>Urbanization and changing lifestyles</b> | Traditional animal-keeping systems may disappear as families move or occupations change.                               |
| <b>Roadside and remote abandonment</b>      | Animals may be left near roads, markets, temples or remote areas where they face traffic, hunger, injury and exposure. |

**They gave us everything... Why do we leave them behind?**

## 4. A MESSAGE TO EVERY FAMILY — POOR, MIDDLE-INCOME OR WEALTHY

Compassion should not become a luxury available only to people with money. At the same time, families with greater resources have a greater practical capacity to fund treatment, shelter and long-term care. The goal is not to shame anyone for being poor; it is to make responsibility possible at every level.

|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>IF MONEY IS VERY LIMITED</b>                          | Give clean water, safe shade, a handful of suitable feed, basic cleanliness and protection from traffic. Call a veterinarian, local animal-care group or municipal service when an animal is seriously ill. Small contributions of time and attention can prevent suffering. |
| <b>IF YOUR FAMILY HAS A STABLE INCOME</b>                | Plan a regular animal-care budget. Help with medicines, veterinary transport, fodder, shelter maintenance or sterilization and vaccination programmes where appropriate. Support a credible local rescue or shelter rather than waiting for emergencies.                     |
| <b>IF YOU ARE FINANCIALLY WELL-OFF</b>                   | Consider sponsoring long-term care, veterinary camps, rescue vehicles, shelters, fodder banks, water facilities and rehabilitation. Use your influence to build systems that continue helping animals after a single donation is spent.                                      |
| <b>IF YOU RUN A FARM, DAIRY OR ANIMAL-BASED BUSINESS</b> | Treat welfare as part of responsible management. Maintain nutrition, clean water, shade, safe flooring, hygiene, preventive healthcare and humane end-of-life planning. Do not treat an old or sick animal as disposable.                                                    |

True responsibility is not measured by wealth alone. It is measured by what we do when a vulnerable life depends on us.

# 5. RESPONSIBILITY CANNOT REST ON RESCUERS ALONE

Individual rescuers can save lives, but sustainable animal welfare needs families, farmers, communities, veterinarians, local bodies and government systems working together.

| COMMUNITY / CITIZENS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PUBLIC AUTHORITIES / SYSTEMS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Report abandoned, injured or severely ill cattle and buffaloes.</li><li>• Support shelters, fodder drives and veterinary care.</li><li>• Keep water points clean and accessible.</li><li>• Do not encourage cruelty, neglect or illegal trading.</li><li>• Help safely with transport and emergency calls.</li><li>• Promote responsible ownership and humane treatment.</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Strengthen implementation of applicable animal-welfare laws and rules.</li><li>• Improve access to veterinary hospitals, mobile care and emergency services.</li><li>• Support shelters and rehabilitation infrastructure.</li><li>• Develop humane systems for abandoned, injured and elderly animals.</li><li>• Improve public awareness and reporting mechanisms.</li><li>• Coordinate veterinary, municipal and animal-welfare services.</li></ul> |

## What rescuers and caregivers add

Rescuers often bridge the gap between emergency and recovery: rescue from danger, safe transport, veterinary assessment, medicines, nutrition, wound care, shelter, rehabilitation and follow-up. Their work should be supported—not used as an excuse for society to abandon responsibility.

## 6. WHEN YOU FIND AN OLD, SICK OR ABANDONED COW/BUFFALO

A calm, organized response can reduce suffering. Serious illness, inability to stand, severe wounds, respiratory distress, repeated collapse, maggot infestation, dehydration or other emergencies require veterinary attention.

|          |                                   |                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>MAKE THE AREA SAFE</b>         | Keep the animal away from traffic, aggressive animals, flooding, extreme heat or cold and other immediate hazards.                                       |
| <b>2</b> | <b>PROVIDE BASIC COMFORT</b>      | Offer clean water when the animal can safely drink, suitable feed, shade or dry shelter, and a comfortable resting surface.                              |
| <b>3</b> | <b>LOOK FOR URGENT SIGNS</b>      | Check for inability to stand, severe bleeding, breathing difficulty, extreme weakness, large wounds, maggots, severe diarrhea or other alarming changes. |
| <b>4</b> | <b>CALL FOR PROFESSIONAL HELP</b> | Contact a veterinarian or appropriate animal-welfare service. Avoid giving medicines without professional guidance, especially human medicines.          |
| <b>5</b> | <b>PLAN BEYOND THE EMERGENCY</b>  | Recovery may require repeated treatment, nutrition, mobility support, shelter, rehabilitation and a long-term caregiver.                                 |

Important: An animal that cannot stand may be suffering from a serious medical or musculoskeletal problem. Forced walking, dragging or rough handling can worsen injury. Seek professional assessment and use appropriate lifting/transport methods.

# 7. OPEN OUR EYES — BEFORE IT IS TOO LATE

The poster's deepest message is not simply “save cows” or “save buffaloes.” It is an appeal to recognize responsibility toward dependent life.

A cow that once fed a family.  
A buffalo that once carried the burden of work.  
An old animal that no longer produces as before.  
A sick animal that cannot stand without help.  
None of these facts make the animal's pain less real

## A SOCIAL PLEDGE

|   |                                                                                                      |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ | I will not measure an animal's worth only by its productivity.                                       |
| ✓ | I will not ignore an old, sick, injured or abandoned animal when I can safely help.                  |
| ✓ | I will seek veterinary or rescue assistance when basic care is not enough.                           |
| ✓ | I will support humane animal welfare within my means—through money, food, time, skills or awareness. |
| ✓ | I will encourage my family, neighbours, businesses and community to act responsibly.                 |

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